MODULE 4

The American West

"It takes a thousand voices to tell a single story."

— NATIVE AMERICAN PROVERB

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did U.S. westward expansion affect different groups in the nation?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Explore the Wild West!**	· Anita Yasuda (illus. Emmanuel Cerisier)	INFORMATIONAL TEXT
2	**The Celestials' Railroad**	· Bruce Watson	MAGAZINE ARTICLE
3	**Homesteading**	· from Prairie Public Broadcasting	MEDIA: VIDEO
4	**A Pioneer Sampler**	· Barbara Greenwood (illus. Heather Collins)	HISTORICAL FICTION

CONTENTS

A · Vocabulary (30) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 12

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 4 · The American West · Grade 5 · 30 Items

CCSS L.5.4 · L.5.5 · L.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.5.6

victory

When you achieve a **victory**, you —

- ◯ **A.** give up before the contest ends.
- ◯ **B.** draw a map of a new place.
- ◯ **C.** overcome a challenge or win against a competitor.
- ◯ **D.** forget the rules of a game.

Q2 L.5.6

native

A plant or animal that is **native** to a place —

- ◯ **A.** was born or first lived in that place.
- ◯ **B.** cannot live there for long.
- ◯ **C.** was brought there from far away.
- ◯ **D.** visits there only in winter.

Q3 L.5.5 TRAP

epic

An **epic** event is one that is —

- ◯ **A.** small and quickly forgotten.
- ◯ **B.** very large and impressive, and sometimes heroic.
- ◯ **C.** quiet and ordinary.
- ◯ **D.** dull and unimportant.

Q4 L.5.6

midland

The **midland** of a country is —

- A. the coast along the ocean.
- B. a tall mountain range.
- C. the border with another country.
- D. the middle part of the country.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · EXPLORE THE WILD WEST!

Q5 L.5.5 TRAP

knowledge

Mountain men used their **knowledge** of the land. If you have **knowledge**, you have —

- A. information or understanding about something.
- B. no idea at all about a topic or how something works.
- C. a large amount of money saved up for a long trip.
- D. a strong fear of trying something that is new to you.

Q6 L.5.4

posts

The trails and **posts** guided the pioneers. **Posts** were —

- A. tall wooden poles that pioneers used to hold up their tents.
- B. letters that pioneers wrote and mailed back home to their families.
- C. large wagons that carried the heaviest loads across the rivers.
- D. forts or stopping places along the trail where people could buy supplies.

Q7 L.5.4

hardships

The ads did not show the daily **hardships** of western life. **Hardships** are —

- A. comforts and easy times that come from having more than you need.
- B. tools and supplies that pioneers used to build a new house.
- C. difficulties or suffering caused by not having enough of something.
- D. gifts that are given to a friend on a special day or holiday.

Q8 L.5.4

patriotic

Others moved west for **patriotic** reasons. People who act in a **patriotic** way toward a country —

- **A.** are visiting from another country.
- **B.** show that they love that country.
- **C.** do not care about that country.
- **D.** have never seen that country.

Q9 L.5.5 TRAP

slogans

Some wagon covers had **slogans** such as "Oregon or Bust." **Slogans** are —

- **A.** short phrases that are catchy and easy to remember.
- **B.** long speeches that are hard to follow and difficult to remember.
- **C.** maps that show the safest way west along the trail.
- **D.** songs that pioneers sang together around the campfire at night.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · EXPLORE THE WILD WEST! (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.5.5 TRAP

handy

Many skills might come in **handy** on the journey. Something that is **handy** is —

- **A.** not useful at all.
- **B.** very useful.
- **C.** made by hand.
- **D.** too heavy to carry.

Q11 L.5.4

typical

A **typical** pioneer diet included bacon and bread. If something is **typical**, it is —

- **A.** strange and rare.
- **B.** brand new.
- **C.** very expensive.
- **D.** usual or normal.

Q12 L.5.5 TRAP

consisted

The pioneer diet **consisted** of bacon, ham, rice, and bread. If something **consisted** of certain items, it —

- ◯ **A.** had none of those things.
- ◯ **B.** was sold to buy those things.
- ◯ **C.** was made up of those things.
- ◯ **D.** was destroyed by those things.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE CELESTIALS' RAILROAD

Q13 L.5.4

celestial

China was called the **Celestial** Kingdom. Something that is **celestial** is —

- ◯ **A.** heavenly.
- ◯ **B.** underground.
- ◯ **C.** made of iron.
- ◯ **D.** very noisy.

Q14 L.5.4

complaint

They worked 12 hours straight without **complaint**. A **complaint** is —

- ◯ **A.** a happy cheer that shows you are pleased.
- ◯ **B.** a quiet song sung to pass the time at work.
- ◯ **C.** an expression of dissatisfaction or pain.
- ◯ **D.** a list of directions for finishing a job.

Q15 L.5.4

employed

The Central Pacific **employed** 12,000 Chinese workers. If you **employed** people, you —

- ◯ **A.** sent them home for the day.
- ◯ **B.** taught them to read.
- ◯ **C.** traveled with them west.
- ◯ **D.** hired them to do a job.

Q16 L.5.4

sacrifice

Their labor and **sacrifice** connected the coasts. A **sacrifice** is —

- ◯ **A.** a reward that you receive for winning a race or a game.
- ◯ **B.** the act of giving up something valued to get something else.
- ◯ **C.** a quick and easy task that takes almost no effort at all.
- ◯ **D.** a tool with a sharp blade that is used for digging holes.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · HOMESTEADING

Q17 L.5.4

homestead

In the late 1800s, a **homestead** was —

- ◯ **A.** a piece of western land that was claimed, lived on, and settled by a pioneer.
- ◯ **B.** a large ship that crossed the ocean.
- ◯ **C.** a busy city in the East.
- ◯ **D.** a railroad station for trains.

Q18 L.5.4

primary

Land was the homesteader's **primary** goal. Something that is **primary** is —

- ◯ **A.** last in line.
- ◯ **B.** first in rank or the highest in importance.
- ◯ **C.** only a small detail.
- ◯ **D.** kept a secret from others.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · HOMESTEADING (CONTINUED)

Q19 L.5.4

domain

The settler worked his own **domain**. Someone's **domain** is —

- ◯ **A.** a borrowed tool.
- ◯ **B.** a faraway city.
- ◯ **C.** the land or territory that he or she owns and controls.
- ◯ **D.** a kind of farm animal.

Q20 L.5.4

residence

They built a small **residence** on the prairie. A **residence** is —

- ◯ **A.** a place to store crops.
- ◯ **B.** a path through the fields.
- ◯ **C.** a kind of wagon.
- ◯ **D.** a place in which people live.

Q21 L.5.5 TRAP

ideology

The Homestead Act grew from an **ideology** about land. An **ideology** is —

- ◯ **A.** a set of beliefs.
- ◯ **B.** a single fact you can prove.
- ◯ **C.** a tool for measuring land.
- ◯ **D.** a place far out west.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · A PIONEER SAMPLER

Q22 L.5.4

frolics

After the harvest came the **frolics**. **Frolics** are —

- ◯ **A.** long days of plowing.
- ◯ **B.** piles of cut wood.
- ◯ **C.** fun acts, such as dances or parties.
- ◯ **D.** tools for the barn.

Q23 L.5.4

stubble

The **stubble** prickled Willy's bare feet. **Stubble** is —

- ◯ **A.** soft, wet mud.
- ◯ **B.** the short, stiff stalks of plants that remain in a field after harvesting.
- ◯ **C.** tall, green grass.
- ◯ **D.** a pile of fresh hay.

Q24 L.5.5 TRAP

indispensable

George acted as though he were **indispensable**. Something that is **indispensable** is —

- ◯ **A.** easy to throw away.
- ◯ **B.** already broken.
- ◯ **C.** too heavy to carry.
- ◯ **D.** necessary.

Q25 L.5.4

dainty

A **dainty** pony skipped by. Something that is **dainty** is —

- ◯ **A.** huge and heavy.
- ◯ **B.** loud and noisy.
- ◯ **C.** delicate.
- ◯ **D.** old and dusty.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · A PIONEER SAMPLER (CONTINUED)

Q26 L.5.5 TRAP

plod

The oxen began a steady **plod**. To **plod** is to —

- ◯ **A.** move heavily and slowly.
- ◯ **B.** run as fast as you can.
- ◯ **C.** leap high into the air.
- ◯ **D.** spin around in circles.

Q27 L.5.5 TRAP

oblivious

He was **oblivious** to everything but the haystack. If someone is **oblivious** to something, he or she is —

- ◯ **A.** closely watching it.
- ◯ **B.** unaware of it.
- ◯ **C.** afraid of it.
- ◯ **D.** excited about it.

Q28 L.5.4

proportions

It became a story of heroic **proportions**. When you talk about the **proportions** of something, you talk about its —

- **A.** color.
- **B.** price.
- **C.** age.
- **D.** size.

Q29 L.5.4

regaled

Willy **regaled** him with the whole tale. If you **regaled** someone, you —

- **A.** ignored them.
- **B.** argued with them.
- **C.** entertained them.
- **D.** forgot about them.

Q30 L.5.4

thresh

They needed time to **thresh** the wheat. To **thresh** a plant is to —

- **A.** beat it in order to separate its grain or seeds from the rest of the plant.
- **B.** water it every day.
- **C.** plant its seeds in a row.
- **D.** tie it into a tall bundle.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 4 · The American West · Grade 5 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.5.1 · RI.5.2 · RI.5.3 · RI.5.5 · RI.5.6 · RI.5.8 · RL.5.1 · RL.5.2 · RL.5.3 · RL.5.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Explore the Wild West!

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · ANITA YASUDA (ILLUS. EMMANUEL CERISIER) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.5.2

What is "Explore the Wild West!" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How Chinese workers built the first railroad across the country, hanging from cliffs and blasting through the mountains.
- ◯ **B.** How pioneers claimed free land on the prairie and turned the open grass into farms and homes.
- ◯ **C.** How pioneers traveled west by wagon in the 1800s, why they went, and what hardships they faced on the trail.
- ◯ **D.** How a young pioneer named Willy worked with his family to save the harvest from the rain.

Q2 RI.5.3

According to the text, how did Sacagawea help Lewis and Clark?

- ◯ **A.** She and her husband translated, and Native Americans who saw her believed the group was peaceful.
- ◯ **B.** She drew the first map of the West and sent it back to President Jefferson.
- ◯ **C.** She guided their wagon train along the Oregon Trail to Independence Rock.
- ◯ **D.** She sold the Louisiana Territory to the United States for $15 million.

Q3 RI.5.3

Why did many pioneers form wagon trains in Independence, Missouri?

- ◯ **A.** The law said that no family could travel west on its own.
- ◯ **B.** Oxen would only pull a wagon when other oxen were nearby.
- ◯ **C.** Each wagon train was given free land by the government.
- ◯ **D.** They believed a large group would keep them safe and bring many useful skills.

Q4 RI.5.8

What evidence does the author give to show that disease was the biggest danger on the trail?

- ◯ **A.** Most pioneers became sick from eating hardtack every day.
- ◯ **B.** Many pioneers died of smallpox and mumps, and cholera caused the most deaths on the trail.
- ◯ **C.** Doctors traveled with every wagon train to care for the sick.
- ◯ **D.** Disease struck only the pioneers who crossed deep rivers.

Q5 RI.5.5

How does the author mainly organize this informational text?

- ◯ **A.** Under headings such as "Moving West" and "Trail Dangers," with sidebars that add extra facts.
- ◯ **B.** As a set of rhyming poems, each one telling about a different pioneer family.
- ◯ **C.** As a make-believe adventure story told by a boy who rides in a covered wagon.
- ◯ **D.** As a single list of steps for packing a wagon before leaving Independence.

Q6 RI.5.6

What is the author's main purpose in writing "Explore the Wild West!"?

- ◯ **A.** To explain, step by step, how settlers built sod houses and farmed the open prairie.
- ◯ **B.** To entertain readers with a make-believe adventure about a family's life in the Old West.
- ◯ **C.** To describe, in order, how the transcontinental railroad finally joined the east and west coasts.
- ◯ **D.** To inform readers about who went west, why they went, and what life on the trail was really like.

Q7 RI.5.3

According to the text, why did most pioneers walk beside their wagons?

- ◯ **A.** The wagon captain did not allow anyone to ride.
- ◯ **B.** Walking helped them find gold along the trail.
- ◯ **C.** To save space for food and lighten the load for the oxen.
- ◯ **D.** They were racing other wagon trains to the West.

Q8 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of "Explore the Wild West!"?

- ◯ **A.** In 1803, the Louisiana Purchase doubled the size of the United States with a single purchase of land.
- ◯ **B.** The journey west was long and full of hardships, but the pioneers' strength and spirit helped shape the nation.
- ◯ **C.** Hardtack did not spoil on the long trip because it was made with no butter or lard.
- ◯ **D.** Independence Rock rose 128 feet high and marked the halfway point on the trail.

Selection 2 · The Celestials' Railroad

MAGAZINE ARTICLE · BRUCE WATSON · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.5.2

What is "The Celestials' Railroad" mostly about?

- **A.** The Chinese workers whose labor and sacrifice built the first railroad across the United States, though no one knows their names today.
- **B.** How pioneer families traveled west by wagon train and faced dangers such as river crossings and disease.
- **C.** A pioneer family working through the harvest, where a boy longs to do "real work" like his brother.
- **D.** How the promise of free land drew homesteaders west to claim and improve 160 acres of prairie.

Q10 RI.5.8

What reason does the article give for why Charles Crocker turned to Chinese workers?

- **A.** They were the only workers in California who already knew how to lay track.
- **B.** They asked to work for no pay at all so they could stay in the country.
- **C.** They already owned part of the railroad company and wanted it finished fast.
- **D.** The Central Pacific had bogged down in the mountains, and most men in California were busy searching for gold or silver.

Q11 RI.5.3

According to the article, why were the Chinese workers known as "Celestials"?

- **A.** Because they worked mostly at night under the stars.
- **B.** Because they called China the Celestial Kingdom.
- **C.** Because they came from the high Sierra Nevada mountains.
- **D.** Because the railroad tycoons gave them that name as a reward.

Q12 RI.5.5

How does the author mainly organize this magazine article?

- **A.** As a play with characters, scenes, and stage directions for actors to read aloud.
- **B.** As a list of directions that tells readers how to build their own railroad track.
- **C.** In time order, telling how the railroad was built and finished, with photographs, captions, and a sidebar.
- **D.** As a collection of poems written by the workers, each about a different mountain.

Q13 RI.5.3

What happened at the ceremony where the two railroads were joined together?

- **A.** The Chinese workers were given the place of honor at the front of the crowd.
- **B.** The ceremony was canceled because heavy rain washed away part of the new track.
- **C.** No photographs were taken at all, so no one could remember that day.
- **D.** When the cameras recorded the event, the Chinese workers were left out of the picture.

Q14 RI.5.6

Why does the author point out that no one knows the Chinese workers' names today?

- ◯ **A.** To show that these workers were treated unfairly and forgotten, even though the railroad was built on their backs.
- ◯ **B.** To explain how trains and tracks are built by big machines today instead of by hand.
- ◯ **C.** To show that the workers did not really do much of the hard work on the railroad.
- ◯ **D.** To prove that the railroad across the country was never finished after all.

Q15 RI.5.1

Which detail from the article BEST supports the idea that the Chinese workers took on dangerous jobs?

- ◯ **A.** They traveled by ship to reach America.
- ◯ **B.** They had never seen a railroad or a train engine before they arrived.
- ◯ **C.** They hung from ropes over cliffs and set dynamite in holes in the mountainsides.
- ◯ **D.** They were paid extra to carry the mail on horseback across the West.

Q16 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of this article?

- ◯ **A.** On April 27, 1869, Central Pacific crews laid 10 miles of track in a single day, a new record.
- ◯ **B.** Chinese workers did dangerous work that built the railroad, yet they faced discrimination and were left out.
- ◯ **C.** The Central Pacific extended east from Sacramento while the Union Pacific headed west from Omaha.
- ◯ **D.** The mountains were hard to cross, so crews blasted tunnels with nitroglycerin.

Selection 3 · Homesteading

MEDIA: VIDEO · FROM PRAIRIE PUBLIC BROADCASTING · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.5.2

What is this video mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How Chinese workers built the first railroad across the country, yet were left out of the famous photograph and the history.
- ◯ **B.** How the Homestead Act gave western land to settlers willing to live on and improve it, and what homesteading life was like.
- ◯ **C.** How pioneer families walked west beside their wagons and faced dangers such as disease.
- ◯ **D.** How a boy named Willy saved a load of hay from the rain during the family's harvest.

Q18 RI.5.3

According to the video, what did the Homestead Act allow people to do?

- ◯ **A.** Ride the railroad for free.
- ◯ **B.** Buy land only in the eastern cities.
- ◯ **C.** Claim 160 acres of land in the West if they would live on it and improve it.
- ◯ **D.** Hunt buffalo on the open plains.

Q19 RI.5.6

Why does the video include a real homesteader's letter along with the narrator's explanation?

- ◯ **A.** To let viewers hear a firsthand voice from the time, not just a later summary of events.
- ◯ **B.** To prove that homesteading never really happened.
- ◯ **C.** To teach viewers how to write a letter.
- ◯ **D.** To show how to plow a field.

Q20 RI.5.3

According to the video, why did President Lincoln support giving land to homesteaders?

- ◯ **A.** He wanted the land to stay empty.
- ◯ **B.** He hoped people would move back east.
- ◯ **C.** He wanted only wealthy people to own land.
- ◯ **D.** He believed that as people succeeded on their own land, they would help develop America.

Q21 RI.5.5

How does the video mainly present its information?

- ◯ **A.** As a single rhyming poem.
- ◯ **B.** As a list of math problems.
- ◯ **C.** Through narration and images, with a primary-source letter and interviews with experts.
- ◯ **D.** As a make-believe fairy tale.

Q22 RI.5.3

According to the video, how were the Homestead Act and the railroads connected?

- ◯ **A.** The railroads made homesteading against the law.
- ◯ **B.** Both helped develop America by bringing people to the undeveloped parts of the West.
- ◯ **C.** The Homestead Act stopped the railroads from being built.
- ◯ **D.** The two had nothing to do with each other.

Q23 RI.5.6

What is the main purpose of this video?

- ◯ **A.** To entertain viewers with a make-believe story about a family living on the prairie.
- ◯ **B.** To convince people today to move west and buy land of their own.
- ◯ **C.** To explain how the transcontinental railroad was built across the mountains.
- ◯ **D.** To inform viewers about homesteading and how it helped settle the American West.

Q24 RI.5.2

Which sentence BEST states a central idea of this video?

- ◯ **A.** The Homestead Act drew pioneers west to claim free land, which demanded hard work and helped develop the country.
- ◯ **B.** President Lincoln supported the Homestead Act because he wanted people to have a chance at land.
- ◯ **C.** The video uses a real homesteader's letter to let viewers hear a voice from the past.
- ◯ **D.** The open prairie had very few trees, so settlers often built their houses out of sod.

Selection 4 · A Pioneer Sampler

HISTORICAL FICTION · BARBARA GREENWOOD (ILLUS. HEATHER COLLINS) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.5.2

What is "A Pioneer Sampler" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How the first railroad across the country was built by Chinese workers who hung from cliffs.
- ◯ **B.** How pioneers traveled west in wagon trains and faced many dangers along the trail.
- ◯ **C.** A pioneer family's hard work during the harvest, told through young Willy, who longs to do "real work."
- ◯ **D.** How a homesteading family built a house of sod and broke the tough prairie soil.

Q26 RL.5.3

At the start of the story, why is Willy unhappy with the job he is given?

- ◯ **A.** He is afraid of the oxen.
- ◯ **B.** He has to carry water and wishes he could do "real work" like his older brother, George.
- ◯ **C.** He does not like the hot weather.
- ◯ **D.** He wants to go to school instead.

Q27 RL.5.3

How does Willy finally prove himself during the harvest?

- **A.** He steers the oxen and saves a load of hay before the rain can ruin it.
- **B.** He wins a race against George.
- **C.** He builds a new barn by himself.
- **D.** He sells the wheat at the market.

Q28 RL.5.1

Which detail BEST shows that Pa is proud of Willy at the end?

- **A.** Pa sends Willy back to carry more water.
- **B.** Pa says nothing to Willy at all.
- **C.** Pa tells Willy to ask George for help.
- **D.** Pa says, "You saved that load. You've got a real farmer's eye for weather."

Q29 RL.5.2

What lesson, or theme, does the story share about pioneer life?

- **A.** Pioneer life took constant hard work, and every member of the family — even a young child — had a part to play.
- **B.** Pioneer children spent most of their days at play and were never once asked to help with the chores.
- **C.** A pioneer farm mostly ran itself, so the harvest came in without much effort from anyone.
- **D.** On a pioneer farm it was always best to finish every job completely on your own.

Q30 RL.5.6

From whose point of view is most of the story told?

- **A.** From the point of view of the oxen.
- **B.** From Pa's point of view.
- **C.** Mostly through Willy's eyes, so readers share his feelings and his wish to do "real work."
- **D.** From the point of view of Uncle Jacob.

Q31 RL.5.3

Why does the author include the family motto, "Eat it up, wear it out, make it do, or do without"?

- **A.** To show that the family wasted everything they had.
- **B.** To show that pioneer families had to be careful and make do with what little they had.
- **C.** To explain how trains were built.
- **D.** To prove that the family was very rich.

Q32 RL.5.2 TRAP

Which sentence BEST states the theme of "A Pioneer Sampler"?

- A. Willy carries water in two buckets to the workers out in the hayfield.
- B. George, the older brother, gets to cut the hay while Willy does the "baby work."
- C. While the family works, a dainty pony skips by in the clouds above the haystack.
- D. Through hard work and cooperation, even a young pioneer can prove that he is needed by his family.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 4 · The American West · Grade 5

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how westward expansion changed the lives of different groups. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Explore the Wild West!,"** Anita Yasuda shows that the West sounded very different in newspaper ads than it was on the trail. Show EACH view, then explain why hearing the pioneers' side matters.

TWO VIEWS OF THE WEST · EXPLORE THE WILD WEST!

WHAT THE NEWSPAPER ADS SHOWED	WHAT PIONEERS REALLY FACED

Why is it important to hear from the pioneers themselves, not just the ads? Use the word *hardships* in your answer.

Q2 Causation DOK 3

In **"The Celestials' Railroad,"** Chinese workers did hard, dangerous work, yet they were left out of the picture. Show the CAUSE and the EFFECT, then explain what was unfair.

WORK AND RECOGNITION · THE CELESTIALS' RAILROAD

WHAT THE CHINESE WORKERS DID	→	HOW THEY WERE TREATED

Why was it unfair that the workers were left out of the picture? Use the word *sacrifice* in your answer.

Q3 Change DOK 3

In **"Homesteading,"** the Homestead Act changed the American West. Show the STEPS, then explain what a homesteader had to do to keep the land.

HOW HOMESTEADING WORKED · HOMESTEADING

THE LAW	WHAT PEOPLE DID	THE RESULT
what did the Homestead Act offer?	*how did settlers respond?*	*how did the West change?*

A homestead was free, but not easy to keep. Why did it take so much hard work? Use the word *homestead* in your answer.

Q4 Community DOK 3

In **"A Pioneer Sampler,"** young Willy wants to do "real work" and finally proves himself. Show the PROBLEM and how he SOLVES it, then explain what the story shows about pioneer families.

WILLY PROVES HIMSELF · A PIONEER SAMPLER

WILLY'S PROBLEM AT THE START	HOW WILLY PROVES HIMSELF

What does the story show about how pioneer families had to work together? Explain using one detail from the story.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: How did U.S. westward expansion affect different groups in the nation? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

Which group does it show, and how did westward expansion affect them?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

Which group does it show, and how did westward expansion affect them?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 4 · The American West · Grade 5

MAP RIT 205 → 225 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Long Walk Home

Tahki had heard the old people speak of the land before the wagons came. Back then, her grandmother said, the prairie stretched on forever, and great herds of buffalo darkened the grass like a moving shadow. The people did not own the land the way a farmer owns a field. They belonged to it, the way a child belongs to a family. Then the settlers arrived, fence by fence, and the herds grew thin. One cold morning, soldiers came to Tahki's village with an order. The people were told to leave the valley where their families had lived for longer than anyone could count. They were to walk to a new place, far away, that the government had chosen for them. Tahki carried her little brother on her back. The walk was long and the winter was cruel, and not everyone who started the journey reached the end. But at night, the elders still told the old stories around the fire, so the children would remember who they were. "They can move us," Tahki's grandmother whispered, "but they cannot take our memory. As long as we tell the stories, we are still a people."

194 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 205–211

Q1 RIT 205 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

According to Tahki's grandmother, how did the people feel about the land long ago?

- ◯ **A.** They wanted to sell it for money.
- ◯ **B.** They belonged to it, the way a child belongs to a family.
- ◯ **C.** They were afraid to walk on it.
- ◯ **D.** They never went near it.

Q2 RIT 207 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

What happened to the buffalo herds after the settlers arrived?

- ◯ **A.** They grew much larger.
- ◯ **B.** They moved into the village.
- ◯ **C.** They grew thin, fence by fence.
- ◯ **D.** They were never seen again that very day.

Q3 RIT 208 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

Why did the soldiers come to Tahki's village?

- ◯ **A.** To help the people plant crops.
- ◯ **B.** To bring food for the winter.
- ◯ **C.** To tell stories around the fire.
- ◯ **D.** To order the people to leave their valley and walk to a new place.

Q4 RIT 210 · Lexile 685L · Inference

Why do the elders keep telling the old stories at night?

- ◯ **A.** So the children will remember who they are, even far from home.
- ◯ **B.** Because they have nothing else to do.
- ◯ **C.** To help everyone fall asleep faster.
- ◯ **D.** To pass the time until the wagons return.

Q5 RIT 211 · Lexile 700L · Theme

What is the main message, or theme, of this passage?

- ◯ **A.** Winter is the hardest season to travel, and a long walk in the cold is dangerous.
- ◯ **B.** When soldiers give an order, the wisest thing a village can do is obey it quietly.
- ◯ **C.** A people can lose their land but still hold on to who they are through their memories and stories.
- ◯ **D.** The great herds of buffalo once darkened the prairie grass like a moving shadow.

Passage 2 · Driving the Golden Spike

For seven years, two railroad companies raced toward each other across the middle of the country. One crew laid track eastward from California, while the other pushed westward from the plains. The work was brutal. Crews blasted tunnels through solid granite, built wooden bridges over deep canyons, and laid heavy iron rails mile after mile. In the steep mountains, much of the most dangerous work was done by Chinese laborers, who were lowered in baskets to chip away at the rock. Through burning summers and freezing winters, the two armies of workers crept closer. On May 10, 1869, they finally met at a dusty spot in Utah called Promontory Summit. A crowd gathered to watch as the last spike, made of gold, was tapped into place to join the two lines. For the first time, a person could travel from one coast to the other in days instead of months. Newspapers called it one of the great wonders of the age. Yet in the famous photograph taken that day, the thousands of Chinese workers who had made the railroad possible were almost nowhere to be seen. The country celebrated the railroad, but it often forgot the hands that had built it.

201 WORDS · LEXILE 740–840L · RIT 211–217

Q6 RIT 211 · Lexile 740L · Key Detail

What were the two railroad companies doing?

- **A.** Racing toward each other to lay track across the country.
- **B.** Building a single station in California.
- **C.** Digging for gold in Utah.
- **D.** Painting bridges over the canyons.

Q7 RIT 213 · Lexile 770L · Key Detail

According to the passage, what dangerous work did Chinese laborers do in the steep mountains?

- **A.** They drove the first trains.
- **B.** They were lowered in baskets to chip away at the rock.
- **C.** They painted the golden spike.
- **D.** They sold tickets to the crowd.

Q8 RIT 214 · Lexile 800L · Cause & Effect

What changed once the railroad was finished?

- **A.** The mountains became flat.
- **B.** The two companies became one town.
- **C.** A person could travel from one coast to the other in days instead of months.
- **D.** The golden spike turned into iron.

Q9 RIT 215 · Lexile 820L · Vocabulary

The passage says the work was **brutal**. The word **brutal** means —

- **A.** easy and pleasant.
- **B.** short and simple.
- **C.** quiet and restful.
- **D.** very harsh and hard.

Q10 RIT 217 · Lexile 840L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Driving the Golden Spike"?

- **A.** The railroad was a great achievement, but the Chinese workers who built it were often forgotten.
- **B.** The last spike driven in at Promontory Summit was made of gold instead of iron.
- **C.** The two railroad companies finally met at a dusty spot in Utah after seven years.
- **D.** Once the railroad was done, a trip between the coasts took days instead of months.

Passage 3 · A Roof of Earth

When the Hansen family reached their claim on the open plains, they found no trees, no streams, and no neighbors — only a wide sea of grass that ran to the edge of the sky. They had come west because the government promised free land to anyone who would live on it and farm it for five years. But the prairie was a hard place to build a home. There was almost no wood. So, like many homesteaders, the Hansens cut blocks of thick prairie sod, the top layer of soil held together by tangled grass roots, and stacked them like bricks to make the walls of a house. They laid more sod across a frame of poles to make the roof. Their "soddy" was dark and cramped, and after a heavy rain, mud sometimes dripped from the ceiling for days. In summer the thick walls kept the house cool, and in winter they held in the heat. Snakes and insects were unwelcome guests. Still, it was a start. Year by year, the Hansens broke the tough sod with a plow, planted wheat, and dug a well. Slowly, the empty claim became a farm, and the farm became a home.

199 WORDS · LEXILE 760–860L · RIT 217–222

Q11 RIT 217 · Lexile 760L · Key Detail

Why did the Hansen family come west?

- ◯ **A.** To work on the railroad.
- ◯ **B.** To visit their neighbors.
- ◯ **C.** Because the government promised free land to anyone who would live on it and farm it for five years.
- ◯ **D.** To hunt buffalo on the plains.

Q12 RIT 218 · Lexile 790L · Cause & Effect

Why did the Hansens build their house out of sod instead of wood?

- ◯ **A.** They thought sod looked nicer.
- ◯ **B.** Wood was against the rules.
- ◯ **C.** They wanted a dark house.
- ◯ **D.** There was almost no wood on the open plains.

Q13 RIT 219 · Lexile 820L · Key Detail

What is "sod," according to the passage?

- ◯ **A.** The top layer of soil held together by tangled grass roots.
- ◯ **B.** A kind of wooden brick.
- ◯ **C.** A tool used to dig a well.
- ◯ **D.** A heavy winter coat.

Q14 RIT 220 · Lexile 840L · Author's Purpose

Why does the author describe both the good and the bad parts of the soddy?

- ◯ **A.** To prove that the plains had many trees.
- ◯ **B.** To show that homesteading was difficult but that the family kept working to make a home.
- ◯ **C.** To explain how to build a railroad.
- ◯ **D.** To tell readers to avoid the West.

Q15 RIT 222 · Lexile 860L · Main Idea

What is the main idea of "A Roof of Earth"?

- **A.** A sod house was dark and cramped and dripped mud after a rain, but its thick walls kept out the summer heat and winter cold.
- **B.** The open plains were full of snakes and insects that crept into the homesteaders' houses.
- **C.** With hard work and clever use of the land, a homesteading family slowly turned an empty claim into a farm and a home.
- **D.** Because there was almost no wood on the plains, the Hansens built their walls from blocks of sod.

Passage 4 · Manifest Destiny

In the middle of the 1800s, a powerful idea swept across the United States. Many people came to believe that the nation was meant to stretch all the way from the Atlantic Ocean to the Pacific Ocean. This belief was given a name: Manifest Destiny. The word "manifest" means clear or obvious, and "destiny" means a future that is meant to be. To those who believed in it, spreading west was not just a choice — it was the country's rightful path. Newspapers printed maps of the wide western lands, and speakers urged families to pack their wagons and go. Spurred on by this idea, hundreds of thousands of settlers traveled west in search of land, gold, and a fresh start. To the U.S. government and the settlers, the growth of the country looked like a great success. But Manifest Destiny had another side. The lands the settlers crossed and claimed were not empty. They were the homelands of many Native nations, who were pushed aside, moved onto reservations, or harmed as the settlers poured in. The same idea that promised opportunity to one group brought deep loss to another. History, it turns out, often depends on who is telling the story.

201 WORDS · LEXILE 860–960L · RIT 219–225

Q16 RIT 219 · Lexile 860L · Vocabulary

According to the passage, what does the term **Manifest Destiny** mean?

- **A.** A law that banned travel to the West.
- **B.** The belief that the nation was meant to stretch from the Atlantic Ocean to the Pacific Ocean.
- **C.** A kind of wagon used by settlers.
- **D.** A map of the eastern states.

Q17 RIT 220 · Lexile 890L · Cause & Effect

How did the idea of Manifest Destiny affect settlers?

- **A.** It convinced most of them to stay in the East.
- **B.** It spurred hundreds of thousands of them to travel west in search of land, gold, and a fresh start.
- **C.** It made them afraid of the western lands.
- **D.** It had no effect on where people lived.

Q18 RIT 221 | Lexile 910L | Key Detail

What was the "other side" of Manifest Destiny that the passage describes?

- ◯ **A.** The settlers ran out of wagons.
- ◯ **B.** The newspapers stopped printing maps.
- ◯ **C.** The gold was harder to find than expected.
- ◯ **D.** The western lands were the homelands of Native nations, who were pushed aside and harmed.

Q19 RIT 223 | Lexile 935L | Author's Purpose

Why does the author end by saying that history "often depends on who is telling the story"?

- ◯ **A.** To show that the same event can look like success to one group and loss to another.
- ◯ **B.** To prove that no one really moved west.
- ◯ **C.** To explain how to draw a map.
- ◯ **D.** To show that newspapers are never correct.

Q20 RIT 225 | Lexile 960L | Main Idea

What is the main idea of "Manifest Destiny"?

- ◯ **A.** Newspapers in the 1800s printed maps of the wide western lands, and speakers urged families to pack up and go.
- ◯ **B.** Spurred on by the idea, hundreds of thousands of settlers packed their wagons and rolled west in search of land, gold, and a fresh start.
- ◯ **C.** The word "manifest" means clear or obvious, and the word "destiny" means a future that is meant to be.
- ◯ **D.** The belief in Manifest Destiny drove settlers west and looked like success, but it brought deep loss to the Native nations already living there.